MMC 4203
Communication Ethics
CRN 82753, Section #601, 3 Credits
College of Arts and Sciences, Department of Journalism and Digital Communication

COURSE SYLLABUS

Semester: Fall 2020
Class Meeting Days: T, Th
Class Meeting Time: 1:00 – 2:15 pm
Class Meeting Location: Microsoft Teams Virtual Classroom
Instructor: Professor Deni Elliott, Poynter Jamison Chair of Media Ethics & Press Policy
Office Location: PRW 204
Office Hours: by appointment via Teams or cell phone; please email to make an appointment
Email: Elliott@usf.edu

I. Welcome!

Ethical reasoning requires the development of skills needed to make good choices under uncertainty. You never have all of the facts that you would like to have prior to making a decision. There is no time in our history in which there has been more uncertainty than today. During this pandemic, citizens in a democracy are called on to decide among actions that could have serious impact on others around them, to determine which media messages to believe, and in this election year, to decide how to choose among candidates for public office. While I am sad not to be meeting with you in person as that is my favorite way to teach, I am really glad to be teaching ethics at a time when many people are eager for the tools that will help them make good choices.

While we'll be thinking about the behaviors of our leaders, our information providers, and citizens, the study of ethics begins (and ends) with the study of oneself. It is easy to judge the behavior of others and to think that you know what is motivating another person. It is not so easy to examine our own choices. Yet, we all are producers and recipients of digital communication. We can all become more ethical in what we share and how we process what is shared with us. Being ethical means being conscious oneself and one's actions. An ethical person is someone who is self-aware, self-reflective, and self-critical.

People who are **self-aware** work hard to notice the ethical implications of choices that they make. They attempt to be honest (at least with themselves) about WHY they are

making particular choices. People who are **self-reflective** know that there are always alternative choices and think about what makes one choice ethically better than another. People who are **self-critical** recognize that they sometimes make choices that are incomplete, inconsistent, or harmful to others. They admit their mistakes. They try to forgive the mistakes of others. They work to be the best people that they can be.

The good news is that MMC 4203 will help you think about all of that and more. This course will help you attain competency in seven of the eight career readiness competencies identified by the National Association of Colleges and Employers. Here are those competencies: critical thinking/problem solving, oral/written communications, teamwork/collaboration, digital technology, leadership, professionalism/work ethic, global/intercultural fluency.

Student/Professor Expectations and COVID-19

Because of COVID-19, this class is meeting remotely. We will meet in a virtual classroom via Microsoft Teams Tuesday and Thursday from 1-2:15 Eastern time. I am available to meet with you outside of class via Microsoft Teams. Send me an email providing a choice of times that you are available to meet and I will schedule a private Teams Meeting with you.

You can easily access the link to our Teams virtual classroom and to your small group venue through the relevant module on our CANVAS course page.

You are expected to attend every class meet via Teams just as you would be expected to attend every class if we were meeting on campus. I do not take attendance, but I do grade some in-class activities. You are accountable for material covered in class even if you haven't attended. There are no make-ups for in-class activities.

Before the Tuesday meeting each week, you are expected to complete the preparation listed in the syllabus and in the CANVAS Module for that week's class meetings. The material that we cover in a particular class may be governed by the topics that students bring up or by what appears in the day's news. As none of us can predict in what order we will cover the week's material, you need to be ready to discuss everything that you have been assigned to read, listen to, or watch in preparation for the week's classes.

Many class meetings will be a combination small group and full class activities. Some in-class activities are graded. The total of in-class activity grades count for 30% of the final grade. You will not know beforehand which activities will be graded because I often decide to grade an activity at the end of class because many students have responded well.

You are expected to respond to course-related email from me or from other students within 24 hours of the message being sent.

Here are some expectations that are reasonable for you to have of me: You can expect me to come to our virtual classroom eager to engage you in conversations about the ethical considerations of timely topics. You can expect that I have significant expertise as an ethics scholar and that I can help you access additional sources outside of class materials and activities. Because I really want you to be successful in this class, you can expect to meet with me one-on-one in scheduled tutorials at least twice in the semester. You can expect me to be available to meet with you as needed to provide additional assistance. You can expect weekly learning goals to be clear and objective. You can expect the evaluation process to be fair and transparent.

II. University Course Description

A study of the fundamental principles and philosophies of ethics and their application of the decision-making process in the various professions of mass communication.

III. Course Prerequisites

MMC 2100 and MMC 3602

IV. Course Purpose

Students who major in the Department of Journalism and Digital Communication are expected to achieve certain competencies before they graduate; every course in the department helps students develop one or more competency.

MMC 4203, a core course in the department, will help you develop three of those competencies. Here's how you can know that you have achieved competency:

HISTORY: *Students will learn how key historical figures, along with contemporary philosophers, contribute to how we think about mass communication ethics today. Students will learn how traditions and conventions of journalism combine with current technology to create principles of practice today.* Graded in-class activities and questions on the concept exam will let students know how well they have developed this competency.

DIVERSITY: *Students will learn how mass communication practices have traditionally given priority to voices of the powerful and the values and culture of dominant society and have discriminated against others based on race, religion, ethnicity, sexual orientation/identity or disability.* Graded in-class activities and questions on the concept exam will let students know how well they have developed this competency. The final case analysis will also show understanding for the need for diversity in mass communication production and in consumption of messages.

ETHICS: *Students will learn the key principles that create standards for mass communication practices; students should also recognize communication ethics as a subset of common morality and be able to articulate values that they express in personal, professional, and civic choices.* Graded in-class activities and questions on the concept

exam will let students know how well they have developed this competency. In addition, the final case analysis will illustrate students' abilities to apply concepts to a complex case.

V. How to Succeed in this Course

Complete all readings, watch all videos, listen to all podcasts assigned BEFORE the Tuesday class each week. Our in-class time is designed to further and deepen knowledge, concepts, and skills based on your preparation.

Respond in small group and full class conversations so that you can test out what you think. You often don't know what you think until you find the words to say what is in your mind. You understand better what you think when someone encourages you to explain your thoughts more fully. You don't have to convince anyone to share your beliefs. Just you speaking your thoughts can make a difference for all of us.

Be civil when you respond to the perspectives of other students. In order to make the best ethical choices, you need to really understand opinions that conflict with your own and to understand why other people hold those different opinions. Instead of being judgmental about other students' thoughts, be curious. Ask, "Can you say more about that?" You don't have to agree with anyone else's beliefs. Just hearing other ideas helps you better understand your own perspective.

VI. Course Topics

1. Self-regarding vs. other-regarding behavior
2. Harm, intent, blameworthiness
3. Reasons for accessing opinion different from your own
4. Community good and enlightened self-interest
5. Role-related responsibilities for citizens, leaders, and mass communication producers
6. Conflicts of interest
7. Spheres of decision-making: self-interest, opinion, religion/culture, law, economics
8. Systematic moral analysis
9. Identification of acts that are morally prohibited, required, permitted and ideal
10. Source credibility and promise-keeping
11. Privacy, secrecy and confidentiality
12. Deception and cheating
13. Leadership and power
14. Hearing voices of the voiceless; recognizing shared humanity with the other
15. Representation and stereotyping

VII. Student Learning Outcomes: By the end of the semester, you should be able to:

- differentiate ethically relevant considerations in specific situations from self-interest, personal opinion, religious belief/cultural conventions, legal requirements, and economic justifications;

- recognize facts, perspectives, theories and analogies needed for ethical analysis and be able to find and use those effectively;
- develop defensible arguments for acts that are morally prohibited, permitted, required, and ideal in specific cases;
- apply ethics-related concepts (including role-related responsibility, conceptualization, justification, harm, justice, conflicts of interest, privacy, deception, cheating, promise-keeping, community and diversity) to communication;
- Write case analyses relating to ethical issues in communication independently, and in collaboration with other students.

VIII. Required Texts

There are two required texts for this course. Both of them are available to you as downloads for FREE:

1. Elliott, D. (2008). *Ethical Challenges: Building an Ethics Toolkit.* Bloomington, IN: Authorhouse. This book is available free as a download from my website: http://digifolio.me/elliott/books/.
2. Elliott, D. and Spence, E. (2018). *Ethics for a digital era.* Hoboken, NJ: Wiley-Blackwell. You may download this book for free through the USF library by going to https://onlinelibrary-wiley-com.ezproxy.lib.usf.edu/doi/book/10.1002/9781118968888.
3. In addition, there are many other readings, videos, podcasts that you are expected to access and study prior to the week that we will discuss them in class. Links or downloadable copies can be found on our CANVAS course site.

IX. Grading Scale

Grading Scale (%)	
94-100	A
90 – 93	A-
87 – 89	B+
84 – 86	B
80 – 83	B-
77 – 79	C+
74 – 76	C
70 – 73	C-
67 – 69	D+
64 – 66	D
60 – 63	D-
0 – 59	F

X. Grade Categories and Weights

Assessment	Percent of Final Grade
In-class Activities (6 @ 5 pts each)	30%
Concept Exam	30%
Final Case Analysis	40%
TOTAL	**100%**

XI. Description of Graded Assignments

1. In-Class Activities (30% of Final Grade)

We will engage in small and large group discussions in almost every class. Learning ethics requires your active involvement. Six of the exercises will be graded on a five-point scale, adding up to 30% of the final grade. Students will be notified after the class period if an in-class exercise has been chosen for grading. Grades will be posted on CANVAS within one week of notification.

Grading Rubric for In-Class Activities:
(5 pts): Shows extreme mastery of concept with no error, encourages response. Furthers the conversation.
(4 pts): Shows good mastery of concept, with little or no error.
(3 pts): Shows some mastery of concept, some error, or response not helpful in encouraging further discussion.
(2 pts): Shows minimal mastery of concept.
(1 pts): Participation, but with significant error or lack of content.
(0 pts): No engagement.

2. Concept Exam (30% of Final Grade)

An exam designed to test student ability to apply concepts learned in the class will be given during the week **of October 4-10.** The test will open at **12:01 AM on Monday, October 5 and will remain open until Friday, October 9 at 11:59 PM**. The exam will include short-answer and essay questions. The test is open-book and open-note. However, students MAY NOT collaborate with one another in taking this exam. **Any strong similarity or consistency between students' essays or any problem noted by proctoring software will result in an inquiry regarding academic dishonesty.**

Students will have 1 ½ hours to complete the exam.

A list of concepts that will be covered on the exam will be available to students no later than **EOD September 19.**

Points will be awarded for correct answers for a total of up to 100 points. Exams will be graded within two weeks of the end of the test period. Students may review their graded exams on CANVAS with the help of a grading rubric, which will be available at the time of review. **We will not have class during the week of October 4-10.**

3. **Final Case Analysis (40% of Final Grade)**
   The final case analysis is **due Tuesday, December 8** by 11:59 PM. During our online class meetings, students will be led in the analysis of several cases that touch on story development, production, delivery and consumption. The final case analysis expects students to show their individual ability to identify and analyze ethical considerations of a case. Students will be able to choose among three cases for their analysis. Students are expected to make specific reference to the concepts in **Ethics for a Digital Era** or in other assigned readings and to use processes described in **Ethical Challenges** in conducting their analyses.

   Grading Rubric for Final Case Analysis:
   Grades for case analyses will be determined as follows:

   (90-100 pts): Met 750-1200 word requirement; identified all ethical issues in the case; demonstrated research that helped clarify the issues and brought additional considerations for analysis; presented a persuasive, articulate and well-organized argument, resulting in a conclusion that clearly differentiated what is ethically permitted, required, or ideal in this case; recognized and responded to a relevant counter-argument; no more than two grammatical or stylistic errors.

   (80-89 pts): Met 750-1200 word requirement; identified most ethical issues in the case; used research that somewhat clarified the issues or brought additional considerations for analysis; presented a somewhat persuasive, articulate and well-organized argument, resulting in an conclusion that differentiated what is ethically permitted, required, or ideal in this case; recognized and responded to one relevant counter-argument; no more than four grammatical or stylistic errors.

   (70-79 pts): Provided an assignment that had one of the following problems: outside of 750-1200 word requirement; failed to identify major ethical issue; failed to use research to clarify the issues or bring forward additional considerations; argument was not well-articulated or well-organized; failed to distinguish acts that are ethically permitted, required or ideal; did not respond to a relevant counter-argument; more than four grammatical or stylistic errors.

   (60-69 pts): Provided an assignment with two of the following problems: outside of 750-1200 word requirement; failed to identify major ethical issue; failed to use research to clarify the issues or bring forward additional considerations; argument was not well-articulated or well-organized; failed to distinguish acts that are ethically permitted, required or ideal; did not respond to a relevant counter-argument; more than four grammatical or stylistic errors.

(50 pts or less): Provided an assignment that had three or more of the following problems: outside of 750-1200 word requirement; failed to identify major ethical issue; failed to use research to clarify the issues or bring forward additional considerations; argument was not well-articulated or well-organized; failed to distinguish acts that are ethically permitted, required or ideal; did not respond to a relevant counter-argument; more than four grammatical or stylistic errors.

(0 pts): Did not provide the assignment by deadline.

XII. Course Schedule*

Week	Finish This Homework Before Class	Topics to be Discussed in Class
Wk I Aug 23-29	Read all of Ethical Challenges (less than 60 pages of text). Do not complete exercises. Read Mill, John Stuart, On Liberty: Chapter II, Of the Liberty of Thought and Discussion (Pg 98-102), Chapter III, Of Individuality (Pg. 103, Pg. 119, Pg. 139), Chapter IV, Of the Limits of Authority (Pg. 140-148, Pg. 151-154). Please see reading notes in relevant module. Complete other prep as described in module.	Ethics & Ethical Reasoning Self-regarding vs. Other-regarding behaviors Reasons for Seeking Divergent Opinion
Wk II Aug 30-Sept 5	Re-read Ethical Challenges. It will make even more sense this time. Read Mill, John Stuart, Utilitarianism: Chapter II, read paragraphs 2-8 and 16; Chapter III, read paragraph 10; Chapter V, read paragraphs 5-10. Please see reading notes in relevant module. Complete other prep as described in module.	Community Good and Enlightened Self-Interest Justice Harm, Intent and Blameworthiness
Wk III Sept 6-12	**TUTORIALS: No Class Meetings** Students will schedule individual meetings with me. The meeting schedule is available on Canvas class site. The meeting will last 15-30 minutes.	Check in to better understand individual student interests or concerns.
Wk IV Sept 13-19	Read Ethics for a Digital Era: Chapter 1-4. Complete other prep as described in module	Role-related responsibilities of leaders, mass communicators and citizens

	Concept list for concept exam distributed by EOD 9/19	Conflicts of Interest
Wk V Sept 20-26	Complete prep as described in module	Source credibility and promise-keeping Distinguishing information from misinformation and disinformation
Wk VI Sep 27-Oct 3	Review Ethical Challenges, paying particular attention to Chapter 2 and Chapter 3 Complete other prep as described in module	Differentiate among spheres of decision-making Practice with SMA
Wk VII Oct 4-10	**Concept Exam: No Class Meetings**	Test your knowledge of concepts taught so far.
Wk VIII Oct 11-17	Read Ethics for a Digital Era: Chapter 7 Complete other prep as described in module	Privacy and Disclosure Confidentiality
Wk IX Oct 18-24	Read Ethics for a Digital Era: Chapter 8 Complete other prep as described in module	Deception Surveillance Cheating
Wk X Oct 25-31	Complete prep as described in module	Ethics of Leadership Ethics and Power
Wk XI Nov 1-7	Complete prep as described in module	Dominant Society and Others
Wk XII Nov 8-14	Complete prep as described in module	Nothing About Us Without Us Stereotyping and Representation
Wk XIII Nov 15-21	**Case Analysis Options Available November 20 EOD**	Small group and full class practice with conducting full case analyses
Wk XIV Nov 22-28	**No Class Meetings (Thanksgiving)** **Drafts due by EOD Saturday, November 28 for Review**	

Wk XV Nov 29-Dec 5	**TUTORIALS: No Class Meetings** Students will schedule individual meetings with me. The meeting schedule is available on Canvas class site. The meeting will last 15-30 minutes.	One-on-one discussion on conducting ethical analysis; review of draft analysis
EXAM WEEK	**Final Case Analysis Due Tuesday, Dec 8 by EOD**	

* Note: The Schedule is subject to revision

XIII. Course Policies: Grades

Late Work Policy:

There are no make-ups for in-class activities or the final case analysis. A make-up for the concept exam will be provided only after submission of written documentation from physician or other equally credible source attesting to the student's inability to complete the exam within the week-long exam period.

Grades of "Incomplete":

The current university policy concerning incomplete grades will be followed in this course. An "I" grade may be awarded to a student only when a small portion of the student's work is incomplete and only when the student is otherwise earning a passing grade. The time limit for removing the "I" is to be set by the instructor of the course. For undergraduate students, this time limit may not exceed two academic semesters, whether or not the student is in residence, and/or graduation, whichever comes first.

Draft Rewrite Policy:

I will review a draft of your final case analysis if the draft is turned in via CANVAS by EOD on **Saturday, November 28**. Draft reviews will be returned to students following their tutorials during the week of **November 29-Dec. 5.**

Exam Retention Policy:

Graded material will be retained on the CANVAS course site.

Group Work Policy:

Everyone must participate in small group meetings. Some small group activities will be graded, with all participants present receiving the same grade. Individuals may change groups, but only if they can find another student willing to switch with them.

Final Examinations Policy:

There is no final exam for this class. **The final case analysis is due by EOD, Tuesday, December 8.**

XIV. Course Policies:

Technology and Media: Please become familiar with the Microsoft Teams Virtual Classroom and your breakout group and with CANVAS before the semester begins. Students are required to have access to a computer with internet access for class meetings to take this course.

Email: All students are expected to respond to class-related emails from me or from other students within 24 hours of the message being sent. I will do the same. Please direct all technology questions regarding Canvas or Microsoft Teams to USF's IT department at (813) 974-1222 or help@usf.edu.

Canvas: This course will be offered via USF's learning management system (LMS), Canvas. If you need help learning how to perform various tasks related to this course or other courses being offered in Canvas, please consult the Canvas help guides. You may also contact USF's IT department at (813) 974-1222 or help@usf.edu.

Microsoft Teams: Our class will meet live in a Microsoft Teams virtual classroom. Closed captioned recordings or transcripts of class meetings will be available for student review. Please contact USF's IT department for assistance.

Online Proctoring: Canvas-based tests and/or quizzes within this course may require online proctoring. For the exam, students are therefore required to have a webcam with a microphone (either USB or mounted into your computer).

XV. Course Policies: Student Expectations

Attendance Policy: Students are expected to attend classes. Students are accountable for material covered in any class that they have missed. There are no make-ups for graded in-class activities.

Academic Integrity: The USF Policy on Academic Integrity specifies that students may not use websites that enable cheating, such as by uploading or downloading material for this purpose. Along with other websites that enable cheating, this policy applies specifically to CourseHero.com – any use of this website (including uploading materials) constitutes a violation of the academic integrity policy.

Collaboration with other students is not allowed on the Concept Exam or Final Case Analysis.

End of Semester Student Evaluations: All classes at USF make use of an online system for students to provide feedback to the University regarding the course. These surveys will be made available at the end of the semester, and the University will notify you by email when the response window opens. Your participation is highly encouraged and valued.

The Writing Studio: The Writing Studio is a free resource for USF students. At the Writing Studio, a trained writing consultant will work individually with you, at any point in the writing process from brainstorming to editing. Appointments are recommended, but not required. For more information or to make an appointment, visit http://www.lib.usf.edu/writing/ or call 813-974-8293.

XVI. Important Dates to Remember

Class-related dates and assignments are subject to change.

First day of class:	Tuesday, August 25
Drop/Add Deadline:	Friday, August 28
Fall graduation application deadline:	Monday, September 21
Concept Exam:	October 4-10
Withdrawal Deadline:	Saturday, October 31
Final Case Analysis Due:	Tuesday, December 8

USF Policies Relevant to Class

Academic Integrity

Academic integrity is the foundation of the University of South Florida's commitment to the academic honesty and personal integrity of its university community. Academic integrity is grounded in certain fundamental values, which include honesty, respect, and fairness. Broadly defined, academic honesty is the completion of all academic endeavors and claims of scholarly knowledge as representative of one's own efforts. The process for faculty reporting of academic misconduct, as well as the student's options for appeal, are outlined in detail in **USF Regulation 3.027**.

Academic Grievance Procedure

The purpose of these procedures is to provide all undergraduate and graduate students taking courses at the University of South Florida an opportunity for objective review of facts and events pertinent to the cause of the academic grievance. An "academic grievance" is a claim that a specific academic decision or action that affects that student's academic record or status has violated published policies and procedures, or has been applied to the grievant in a manner different from that used for other students.

COVID-19 Procedures

The health and safety of students, faculty, staff and visitors on our campuses is our top priority. In response to the current COVID-19 pandemic, the USF community will be working together to support compliance with recommended health and safety standards to optimize the learning

experience while minimizing health risks. The Conduct Expectations for all members of the community may be accessed at **Conduct Expected to Support USF Health and Safety Standards** with details provided below:

Students and faculty will be guided by established USF processes to ensure the safest possible non-disruptive environment including the:
(1) **Academic Disruption Regulation** which provides for an immediate removal or restriction from a classroom setting with academic sanctions and/or
(2) **Student Conduct Regulation** to address conduct that is inconsistent with the expectations as outlined below:

1. **Complete daily screening as requested.** Anyone experiencing one or more COVID-19 symptoms should not be on campus or, if a resident, should not be outside their residence hall room and should contact a medical provider immediately and follow their guidance. Please inform your instructor prior to the beginning class if your screening indicates the need for further evaluation and you will not be in class.
2. **Wear face coverings.** All members of the USF community are required to wear face coverings while in classrooms or any other shared space, including specified public or common-use areas where social distancing guidelines cannot be followed. See this link on **How To Make A Face Mask**. If you have to use a disposable face mask, please discard it in a trash receptacle immediately after use.
3. **Maintain social distancing.** All students, faculty, staff and guests are required to maintain a safe distance from one another. Social distancing is maintained in all indoor and outdoor spaces which are owned or controlled by USF. Stay at least 6 feet (about 2 arms' length) from other people, do not gather in groups, stay out of crowded places and avoid mass gatherings. See the CDC for information on **Social Distancing**. Please sit in only designated areas in class and do not move chairs or desks in classrooms or common spaces.
4. **Practice good hand hygiene.** Individuals should wash their hands with soap and water for at least 20 seconds as often as possible or use personal hand sanitizers containing at least 60% alcohol. Hand sanitizer stations are available throughout the campus. If you see one, use it! See the CDC recommendations on **Hand Hygiene**.
5. **Disinfect your classroom space.** Students and faculty are responsible for disinfecting areas within their workspaces by cleaning these at the beginning and end of each class. This includes desk tops, seats, and equipment used during class. Disinfectant supplies will be provided. If paper towels are used to disinfect, they must be discarded in a trash receptable immediately after use.

Disability Access
Students with disabilities are responsible for registering with Students Accessibilty Services (SAS) (SVC 1133) in order to receive academic accommodations. SAS encourages students to notify instructors of accommodation needs at least five (5) business days prior to needing the accommodation. A letter from SAS must accompany this request. Please visit the **Student Accessibility Services website** for more information.

Disruption to Academic Progress
Disruptive students in the academic setting hinder the educational process. Disruption of the academic process (**USF Regulation 3.025**) is defined as the act, words, or general conduct of a student in a classroom or other academic environment which in the reasonable estimation of the instructor: (a) directs attention away from the academic matters at hand, such as noisy distractions, persistent, disrespectful or abusive interruption of lecture, exam, academic discussion, or general University operations, or (b) presents a danger to the health, safety, or well-being of self or other persons.

Food and Housing Insecurity
We recognize that student facing financial difficulty in securing a stable place to live and/or in affording sufficient groceries may be at risk of these financial issues affecting their performance in classes. Students with these needs are urged to contact Feed-A-Bull (**feedabull@usf.edu** or **their website**), or Student Outreach and Support (**socat@usf.edu** or **their website**).

Religious Observances
All students have a right to expect that the University will reasonably accommodate their religious observances, practices and beliefs (**USF Policy 10-045**). The University of South Florida, through its faculty, will make every attempt to schedule required classes and examinations in view of customarily observed religious holidays of those religious groups or communities comprising USF's constituency. Students are expected to attend classes and take examinations as determined by the university. No student shall be compelled to attend class or sit for an examination at a day or time prohibited by his or her religious belief. However, students should review the course requirements and meeting days and times to avoid foreseeable conflicts, as excessive absences in a given term may prevent a student from completing the academic requirements of a specific course. Students are expected to notify their instructors at the beginning of each academic term if they intend to be absent for a class or announced examination, in accordance with this Policy.

Sexual Misconduct / Sexual Harassment
USF is committed to providing an environment free from sex discrimination, including sexual harassment and sexual violence (**USF Policy 0-004**). The USF Center for Victim Advocacy is a confidential resource where you can talk about incidents of sexual harassment and gender-based crimes including sexual assault, stalking, and domestic/relationship violence. This confidential resource can help you without having to report your situation to either the **Office of Student Rights and Responsibilities** (OSSR) or the **Office of Diversity, Inclusion, and Equal Opportunity** (DIEO), unless you request that they make a report. Please be aware that in compliance with Title IX and under the USF Policy, educators must report incidents of sexual harassment and gender-based crimes including sexual assault, stalking, and domestic/relationship violence. If you disclose any of these situations in class, in papers, or personally to an educator, he or she is required to report it to OSSR or DIEO for investigation. Contact the USF **Center for Victim Advocacy**: 813-974-5757.

Statement of Academic Continuity
In the event of an emergency, it may be necessary for USF to suspend normal operations. During this time, USF may opt to continue delivery of instruction through methods that include, but are not limited to: Learning Management System, online conferencing, email messaging, and/or an alternate schedule. It is the responsibility of the student to monitor the Learning Management System for each class for course-specific communication, and the main USF, College, and Department websites, emails, and MoBull messages for important general information (**USF Policy 6-010**). For additional guidance on emergency protective actions and hazards that affect the University, please visit **www.usf.edu/em**

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